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MOSCOW'S RESPONSE to this attempt at quiet diplomacy was a cold shoulder: Ambassador Dobrynin told George Shultz the Soviet leadership wasn't interested in a summit and Chernenko's reply stated that he had no interest in pursuing a dialogue without acts of "concrete, weighty substance" on the part of the United States—which to him meant removing the Pershing II and cruise missiles. Here are excerpts from his letter, which, like mine, was seven pages long:

> We have already made it known to the United States before, but since you go back again to the matter of intentions and how they can be perceived, I will express thoughts and illustrate them with specific examples:
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> If one is to summarize what was on many occasions publicly stated by you and other representatives of your administration, the bottom line will be that the United States would only agree with such a situation where it would be militarily ahead of the USSR. But the point of the matter is that we, however, have not agreed nor do we agree with such a situation. In this respect, we have some experience earned the hard way. The history of our relations, especially the postwar period, has seen quite a few complications too; quite a few attempts were made to exert political, economic as well as military pressure on us.
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> It appears to be an American idiom to put somebody in someone else's shoes. I ask you, Mr. President, to look at the realities of the international situation from our perspective, and you will see right from the start